

# Shadow In The Dark - User Guide

## Introduction

Welcome to **Shadow in the Dark**, a thrilling survival game where you must navigate through darkness, find a match, and light a candle before fear consumes you. A mysterious shadow monster lurks in the darkness, growing closer with each passing moment.

Compete with friends in multiplayer mode to see who can survive with the lowest fear level. Will you keep your cool, or will the shadows claim you?



---

## Requirements

To play Shadow in the Dark, you need:

- A web browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
- An internet connection
- The game file ([Shadow In The Dark.s](#))



---

## Getting Started

Follow these steps to load and start playing the game:

### Step 1: Download Game File

Ensure you have the [Shadow In The Doubt.s](#) file saved on your computer. If you received the file via email or download link, save it to a location you can easily find (such as your Desktop or Downloads folder).

### Step 2: Open CPUlator

Open your web browser and paste this link into the address bar:

<https://cpulator.01xz.net/?sys=rv32-spim>

Press Enter to load the CPUlator website. You will see a screen with several panels, including an editor area in the center, and a “File” dropdown at the top.

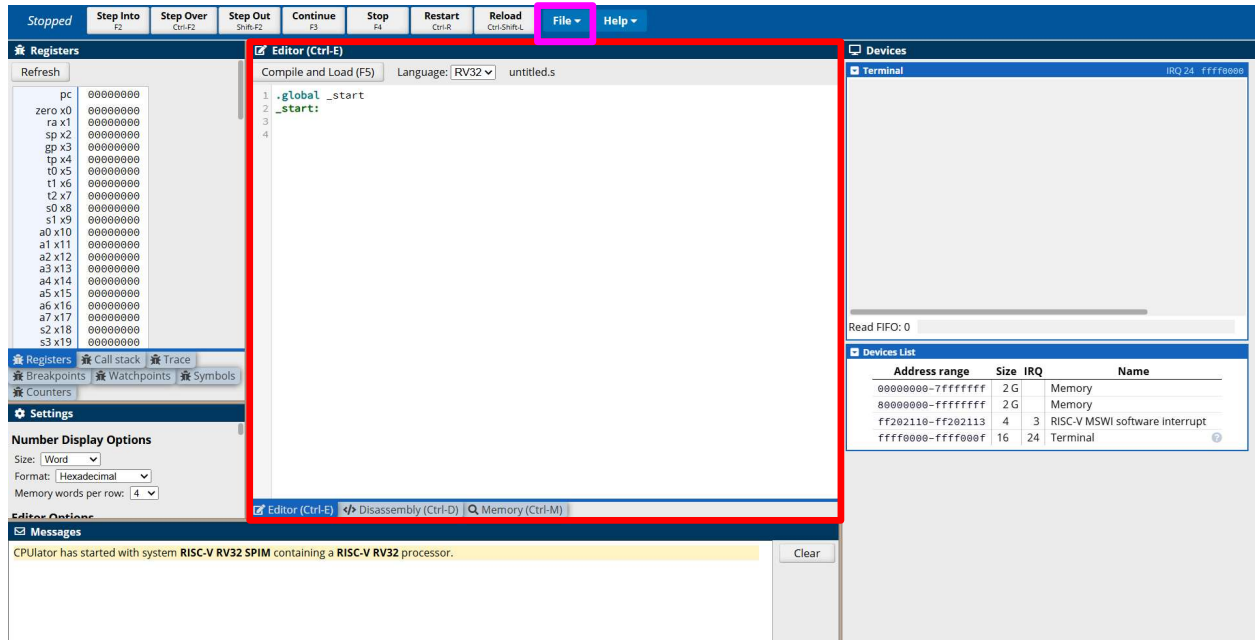


Figure 1: CPUlator interface showing the editor panel where you will upload your game code

### Step 3: Load Game File

In CPUlator:

1. Click **File** in the top menu.
2. Select **Open...**
3. Browse to the **Shadow In The Doubt.s** file on your computer.
4. Click **Open**.

The contents of the file will automatically appear in the editor panel.

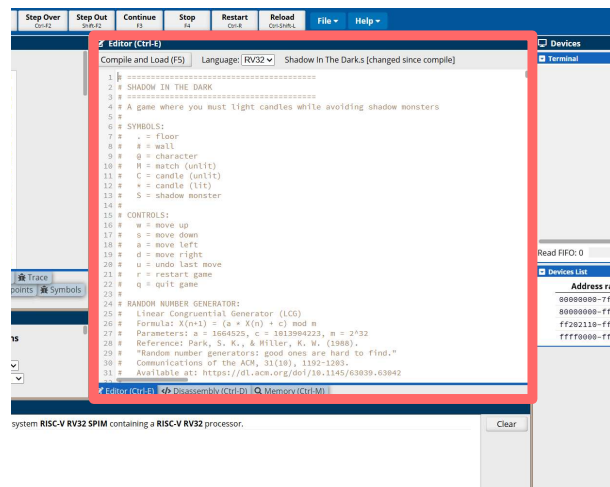


Figure 2: Game code pasted into the CPUlator editor

### Step 4: Compile & Start Game

At the top of the CPUlator window, click **Compile and Load** to prepare the program. Once it finishes compiling, click **Continue** to start the game.

The game will begin running in the terminal window next to the Editor window, where you'll see the game's welcome message and instructions.

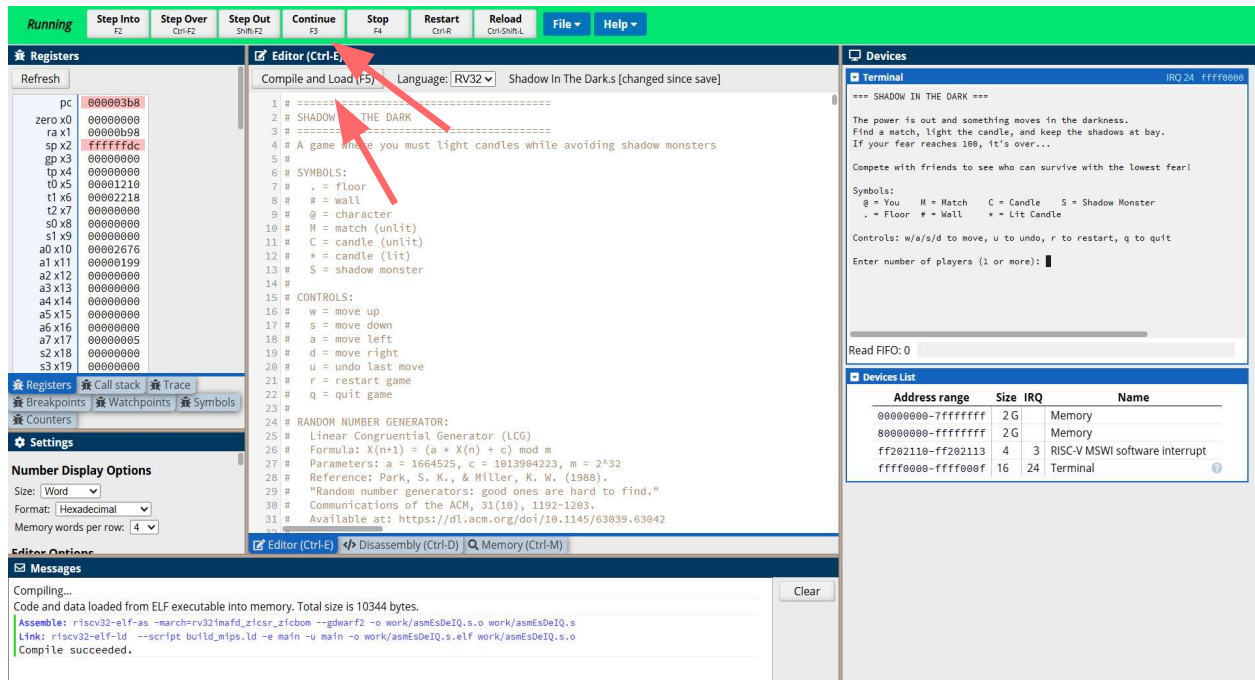


Figure 3: Use “Compile and Load” and “Continue” buttons to start the game

## Game Setup

When you start the game, you will be asked to configure a few settings before playing.

### Number of Players

The game will first ask: **Enter number of players (1 or more):**

Type the number of players who will be competing (for example, type **2** for two players or **1** to play alone). Press Enter.

**Note:** You must enter at least 1 player. If you enter an invalid number (such as 0 or a negative number), the game will ask you to try again.

### Board Size

Next, the game will ask you to set the size of the game board:

- Enter board width (minimum 5):** Type a number for how wide you want the board.

2. **Enter board height (minimum 5):** Type a number for how tall you want the board.

For example, entering 8 for both width and height creates an 8×8 game board; however, the actual playable area will be 6×6, since the outer border is made up of walls.

### Important Notes:

1. The minimum size is 5×5, because anything smaller would make the game unplayable; everything would be crammed together, and the shadow monster could respawn in the same spot, breaking the game rules.
2. Choosing a very large board may cause the layout to look strange in the terminal, requiring horizontal scrolling and making it harder to play.
3. Larger boards also make the game more challenging since there's more area to explore and the shadow monster has more space to move.

## How to Play

### Game Objective

Your goal is to:

1. Find the match (marked with **M** on the board)
2. Pick up the match by moving onto it
3. Find the candle (marked with **C** on the board)
4. Light the candle by moving onto it while carrying the match
5. Don't let the shadow monster get next to you; it adds 10 fear, respawns, and then approaches you again.

```
#####  
#...M.....#  
#.....#  
#.....C#  
#.....#  
#...S.....#  
#.....#  
#...@.....#  
#.....#  
#####
```

Figure 4: Game Board

**Win Condition:** Successfully light the candle before your fear reaches 100.

**Lose Condition:** Your fear reaches 100, and the shadows consume you.

### Understanding the Game Board

When you play, you will see a grid representing your game world. Here's what each symbol means:

| Symbol | Meaning                                  |
|--------|------------------------------------------|
| @      | Your character (this is you!)            |
| M      | Match (pick this up first)               |
| C      | Candle (unlit)                           |
| *      | Candle (lit - you win!)                  |
| S      | Shadow Monster (avoid being next to it!) |
| .      | Empty floor space (safe to walk on)      |
| #      | Wall (you cannot move through walls)     |

## Movement Controls

Move your character using these keyboard keys:

- **W** - Move up
- **A** - Move left
- **S** - Move down
- **D** - Move right

**Important:** You cannot move through walls (# symbols) or off the edges of the board. If you try to move into a wall, you will see the message "Invalid move! Can't move there." and your character will not move. The shadow monster will also stay still during that turn.

## Fear Gauge

Your fear level starts at 0. The shadow monster hunts you throughout the game. When the shadow monster moves next to your character (including diagonally), your fear increases by 10 points.

The game displays your current fear level whenever it increases: **Fear gauge: 30**

If your fear reaches 100, the game ends and you lose.

## Game Flow

1. **Pick up the match:** Move your character onto the M symbol. You will see the message: "You picked up a match!"

2. **Find the candle:** After picking up the match, navigate to the **C** symbol on the board.
3. **Light the candle:** Move onto the candle while carrying the match. The candle will light (changing to **\***), and you will see: "You lit the candle! You survived the night!"

**Note:** If you try to light the candle without the match, you will see: "You need a match to light the candle!"

## Restart

If you want to restart your current turn, press **R**. You will see the message "Game restarted!", and the board will reset to its starting positions for your turn. Your fear gauge will also reset to 0.

**Note:** This only restarts your current turn, not the entire game; other players' progress remains unaffected.

## Quit

Press **Q** to exit the entire game at any time.

---

## Multiplayer Mode

Shadow in the Dark supports competitive multiplayer! Multiple players can compete to see who can survive with the lowest fear level.

### How Multiplayer Works

1. **Same Map for Everyone:** All players play on the exact same map layout. The character, match, candle, and shadow monster start in identical positions for each player. This ensures the competition is fair.
2. **Turn-Based Play:** Players take turns one at a time. The game will display whose turn it is:

=====

>>> PLAYER 1'S TURN

=====

3. **Player Switching:** After one player finishes their game (either by lighting the candle or reaching 100 fear), the game will display their final fear score:

>>> Player 1 finished with fear: 35

Press ENTER for next player...

The next player should then press Enter to begin their turn.

4. **Scoring:** The player's final fear gauge at the end of their game becomes their score. Lower scores are better!

## Viewing Results

After all players have finished, the game displays a final leaderboard showing rankings:

=====

### FINAL LEADERBOARD

=====

1. Player 2 => Fear: 20

2. Player 1 => Fear: 35

3. Player 3 => Fear: 50

The game will announce the winner:

>>> WINNER: Player 2 with 20 fear!

**Ties:** If multiple players finish with the same fear score, the game will announce a tie:

>>> TIE: Player 1 & Player 3 with 40 fear!

```
=====
                        FINAL LEADERBOARD
=====
1. Player 1 => Fear: 20
2. Player 2 => Fear: 20
3. Player 3 => Fear: 20
>>> TIE: Player 1 & 2 & 3 with 20 fear!
=====
```

Figure 5: Final Leaderboard Showing Player rankings

---

## Undo Feature

Shadow in the Dark includes an unlimited undo feature that lets you take back your moves if you make a mistake.

### How to Undo

Press **U** to undo your last move. The game will reverse your previous action, restoring:

- Your character's position
- The shadow monster's position
- Your fear level
- Whether you had picked up the match

You will see the message: "Undo successful!"

## Unlimited Undos

You can press **U** multiple times to undo several moves in a row. The game remembers all your moves during your current turn, so you can undo as far back as you need.

If you try to undo when there are no moves to undo (such as at the very start of your turn), you will see: "Nothing to undo!"

## When Undo Resets

The undo history clears when you:

- Start a new game
- Press **R** to restart your turn
- Finish your turn in multiplayer mode

---

## Tips for Success

1. **Plan Your Path:** Before moving, look at where the shadow monster is and plan a route that keeps you away from it.
  2. **Use Undo Wisely:** If the shadow monster gets too close and increases your fear, use the undo feature to try a different path.
  3. **Speed Matters:** The shadow monster moves toward you after each of your moves, so take the shortest path possible to the match and then to the candle.
  4. **Corner Awareness:** Try not to get trapped in corners where the shadow monster can easily reach you.
  5. **Practice Makes Perfect:** Play a few solo games to learn the controls and strategy before competing in multiplayer mode.
-



## Quick Reference

### All Controls

- **W** - Move up
- **A** - Move left
- **S** - Move down
- **D** - Move right
- **U** - Undo last move
- **R** - Restart current turn
- **Q** - Quit game

### All Symbols

- @ = You
  - M = Match
  - C = Candle (unlit)
  - \* = Candle (lit)
  - S = Shadow Monster
  - . = Floor
  - # = Wall
- 

## Frequently Asked Questions

### Q: Can I move diagonally?

A: No, you can only move up, down, left, or right using the W, A, S, D keys.

### Q: What happens if I move next to the shadow monster?

A: Your fear increases by 10 points. If the shadow monster is adjacent to you (including diagonally), your fear will increase.

### Q: Can the shadow monster move through walls?

A: No, the shadow monster follows the same movement rules as you and cannot move through walls.

### Q: Can I change the board size during the game?

A: No, the board size is set at the beginning of the game. You would need to quit (press Q) and restart the entire game to change it.

---

***Good luck, and may you survive the darkness!***